

The Fox Who Learned to Wait

Once, in a quiet forest at the edge of a wide river, there lived a young fox named Bramble. Bramble was clever, quick, and always in a hurry. He believed that the fastest animal in the forest deserved the best food, the best den, and the best stories to tell.

One autumn morning, Bramble spotted a cluster of ripe grapes hanging from a vine that stretched high above a stone wall. He leapt again and again, but the grapes stayed just out of reach. Frustrated, he was about to give up and call the grapes sour and worthless.

Just then, an old tortoise named Pebble shuffled by. "Why not wait for the wind?" Pebble asked calmly. "A strong gust will bend the vine low enough for you to reach." Bramble scoffed at the idea of waiting, but he had no better plan, so he sat down beside the tortoise.

They waited through the morning, and Bramble grew restless. But as the sun rose higher, a warm breeze rolled in from the river, bending the vine just as Pebble had said. Bramble reached up and finally tasted the sweetest grapes he had ever known.

From that day on, Bramble still ran fast through the forest, but he no longer scorned patience. He had learned that some things could not be rushed, and that even the quickest fox could learn a thing or two from a slow, steady tortoise.

The End.